i want you to give me an interesting idea for a video game

Tidewright

You play as the last lighthouse keeper on a world where the ocean doesn't behave like water. It's a slow, living tide that rises and falls on a cycle of roughly 24 real-time hours, and what it reveals and swallows is the heart of the game.

The hook: The sea is the map. At low tide, the seabed is walkable: shipwrecks, drowned towns, and sunken markets lie exposed. At high tide, all of that vanishes beneath the waves, and the world shrinks to your lighthouse and a handful of rocky islands. You explore during low tide, then retreat before the water returns.

What makes it interesting:

- **The tide is persistent and shared.** It follows a real-world clock, so you can't just grind for hours. When the water comes in, you have to deal with it. Some places can only be reached at the lowest tides, which happen once every few days.
- **The drowned things remember.** Each time the tide returns and recedes, the seabed has rearranged itself. Wrecks drift, new ones surface, old ones are buried in silt. You keep a tide journal, because patterns matter: a map from last week is partly wrong.
- **Your lamp is your only tool.** The lighthouse beam can calm, attract, or repel the creatures that live in the deep. Aim it wrong and you wake something. Aim it right and a vast, patient thing will rise beside your tower and show you something.
- **A quiet mystery.** Each shipwreck holds a letter, a logbook, or a trinket. Piece them together and you learn why the sea stopped being water, and who made the keepers.

The feel: Think *Outer Wilds* meets *Dredge* meets *Stardew Valley's* rhythm. Cozy and eerie at once, with no combat, just observation, timing, and a growing sense that the ocean is trying to tell you something.

Want me to flesh this out further, say the core gameplay loop, the story, or a different genre take (like a multiplayer version where keepers across the world share one tide)?

yes explain more, also what about "time travel" like in Animal Crossing when players just change the system clock to advance, and what would the player do in the lighthouse while the water comes. is there a motivation for the player to explore the debris not just to learn about the sea?

The Core Loop

A day in *Tidewright* has two halves.

Low tide (the expedition): The sea draws back and you have a few real hours to walk the seabed. You can only carry so much, and the water comes back on schedule, so every trip is about choosing what's worth hauling home and when to turn back. A watch on your wrist shows the tide's return as a creeping line, so you always know how much time you have.

High tide (the lighthouse): The sea covers everything and you're stuck in your tower. This is the game's second half, not downtime.

What You Do in the Lighthouse

- **Restore salvage.** Everything you bring back is waterlogged, corroded, or fragile. At your workbench you dry logbooks page by page, clean tarnished instruments, and reassemble broken objects. Restoring a logbook is a small puzzle (matching torn pages, deciphering smeared ink).
- **Tend the lamp.** The lamp needs oil, wicks, and lens polishing, and it's also your main way of interacting with the deep. At night you aim the beam and watch what answers. Some creatures only surface for a certain color of light, and finding those combinations is its own kind of exploration.
- **Receive visitors.** At high tide, strange things drift up to your tower: a ghost ship that docks for one night, a creature that wants to trade, a drowned traveler's echo that asks you to deliver something. This is where your salvage gets used.
- **Maintain the tower.** Floors flood, stairs rust, and rooms need repair. The building is a project in itself, and you upgrade it into a workshop, an observatory, a library, and so on.
- **Keep the tide journal.** You chart where wrecks drifted, predict the next low tide, and plan your route. The planning is much of the strategy.

Motivation Beyond Lore

Yes, and this is what keeps the game from being purely a mystery box. Three layers:

1. **The tide is winning.** Each cycle, the high-water mark climbs a little higher up your tower. It's slow, but it's there. You're racing to find the means to stop or reverse it, so exploration is survival, not curiosity.
2. **Salvage is your economy.** The tower can't repair itself. Better lenses, tools, and diving gear all come from the seabed, and rarer wrecks hold rarer parts. You always have a concrete reason to go deeper or farther.
3. **The drowned have unfinished business.** Wrecks hold letters never delivered, heirlooms, debts. Return an item to the right creature or visitor and you earn their help, their trade, or a piece of the world opening up. Exploring becomes a kind of quiet service, which suits the cozy tone.

The mystery of *why* the sea changed becomes the long-term payoff, not the only reason to play.

The Time Travel Problem

Changing the system clock is a real issue here, because the tide is the whole game. There are a few ways to handle it:

- **Give players a legitimate fast-forward.** A brass tide-clock in the tower that you can crank forward, at a cost (oil, or a "slack tide" that makes the next low tide shorter). Most people who clock-skip just want to skip waiting, so give them a sanctioned way to do it.
- **Make cheating diegetic.** If the game detects a jump, the sea reacts: the skipped tides become storm surges, wrecks scatter, and rare sites sink deeper. You can skip, but the sea remembers.
- **Count witnessed tides, not elapsed time.** Rare events (like the once-a-week lowest tide) are tied to a counter of tides you've actually experienced. Skipping the clock doesn't burn through them, because the sea waits for you.

My pick would be a combination of the first and third: an in-game way to speed things up, plus rare events locked to what you've actually witnessed. That way skipping is fine for the impatient, but it can't spoil the special moments.

Want me to dig into the story next, like who the keepers were and what happened to the sea? Or sketch the first hour of play?

the story and gameplay fits as a single player game,in my opinion, what do you think? also will the same visitors can visit multiple times or it's a one time visit and if you have the item you give it and if not missed chance?

I agree with you. Single-player is the right call, and I'd go further: the design gets worse if you make it multiplayer.

Why single-player fits

- **The tone depends on solitude.** The whole mood is one keeper, one tower, a sea that seems to be speaking only to you. Other keepers wandering the seabed would break that.
- **The tide is a personal rhythm.** In multiplayer you'd have to reconcile everyone's schedules and time zones, and the "I'm choosing when to turn back" tension would turn into coordination.
- **The mystery wants one pair of eyes.** Piecing together logbooks and letters is a private, slow act of detective work. Shared lore tends to get solved by a wiki in a week.
- **Restoration and journaling are intimate.** Those are quiet, hands-on activities that don't gain much from other people.

The one thing you'd lose is the shared "the sea is the same for everyone" idea, but you can keep a trace of it with optional asynchronous touches, like finding a message in a bottle from another player's game. That's still a single-player experience.

Do Visitors Return?

I'd say **mostly yes, with a few exceptions**, because a pure "miss it and it's gone" system works against a cozy game. Here's how I'd split it:

Recurring visitors (the majority). These are the characters you build relationships with. They come back every few tides, and each visit moves their story forward. If you couldn't help them this time, they remember. They might leave disappointed, mention what they were hoping for, and return later, so a missed chance becomes a **lead**, not a loss. "You didn't have my brother's compass? Then I'll be back at the next spring tide. Look for it in the northern wrecks." That feeds directly back into exploration.

Rare one-night visitors (a handful). A ghost ship that docks once, an echo that appears only at a certain tide. Because these are rare and special, missing them stings a little, and that's the point. They make the world feel alive instead of like a checklist. I'd keep these few and make sure none of them gate essential progress.

Seasonal visitors. Some only come during particular tide conditions, like the lowest tide of the month or a storm surge. You can miss one, but it will come around again.

Why This Balance Works

- **No permanent punishment for a cozy game.** Players who feel they "ruined" a questline stop enjoying it. Recoverable misses keep it relaxed.
- **Missed chances still matter.** The visitor's reaction, a delay, or a worse reward gives choices weight without locking anything away.
- **Rarity creates memorable moments.** If everything returns, nothing feels special. A few truly one-time encounters give players stories to tell.

A useful rule of thumb: anything that affects the main mystery or the lighthouse's survival can always be recovered. Anything purely emotional or flavorful can be missable.

One more idea: a **"left behind" shelf** in the tower. If a visitor leaves because you lacked their item, they might leave something small as thanks for trying, or a note, so even a failed visit gives you something.

Want me to design a few specific visitors next, maybe one recurring character with a full multi-visit arc and one rare one-night encounter?

what do you see for the start of the game? is there explanation how the player got to the lighthouse, did he woke from something and saw the change in the sea? the changes every tide is like a rouge-like game, i don't think implementing buffs and skill active for only one exploration fits the game. but you can make the salvage and debris resource for crafting, and improve you stuff to have better mechanics, like building a cart to cover more ground faster. visitors are only a mystical and eerie creatures?

The Opening

I'd start with **no explanation, but a lot of clues.** The player wakes up in the lighthouse's lamp room, the highest point of the tower, and the first thing they see is the sea pulled back for the first time. A single hand-written note is pinned beside the lamp: instructions from the previous keeper, unfinished mid-sentence.

The first ten minutes:

1. You wake to a dark lamp and a grey dawn. The tower is half-ruined but lived-in: a cold stove, a bed, a half-eaten meal that has been sitting for who knows how long.
2. You climb down to the door and open it. The sea is gone. Where water should be there's a vast, glistening seabed stretching to the horizon, with masts poking out of the mud.
3. A short tutorial expedition: reach the nearest wreck, salvage a first tool, and turn back as the water starts to return. Your first high tide is your first lesson in the loop.

How did you get here? My suggestion is to leave it ambiguous at first, then let it unfold in layers:

- You don't know your name, but the logbooks do. Early on you find your own handwriting in old entries, dated years apart, which raises the question of how long you've actually been here.
- The previous keeper's note hints that keepers "wake" when the lamp is needed. The sea didn't just change; **you were summoned back to tend it.**
- A late-game reveal could be that the keepers are not entirely human, or that the sea itself chose them. This ties into the mystery of who made the keepers.

Waking with amnesia is a well-worn trope, so I'd avoid the generic "you forgot everything" version. Instead, you remember how to be a keeper (the lamp, the tide tables, the knots) but not your own life. That gives you competence from the start while the personal story stays open.

No Temporary Buffs

You're right, and it's a sharp observation. Roguelike-style one-run buffs would pull the game toward a different genre. Here is how I'd build progression instead:

Permanent, crafting-based progression. Everything you bring back becomes a lasting improvement:

- **Cart:** starts as a wheelbarrow, upgrades to a wide-wheeled mudcart, then a sled for soft silt, then perhaps a light sail-cart that uses the wind on the open flats. Each stage means more carrying capacity and faster travel.
- **Boots and tools:** mudshoes that keep you from sinking, a probe for testing the ground, a longer hook for pulling debris out of wrecks.
- **Lighting:** lanterns with different colors and ranges for the seabed itself, not just the tower beam.
- **Tide instruments:** a better tide table, a barometer, a brass sextant that predicts the next low tide more precisely.
- **Diving gear (late game):** the first time you can go below the lowest waterline during high tide opens a whole new layer of the map.

The roguelike element, if you want it, stays in the world, not the player. The seabed reshuffles each cycle, so *what you find* changes, but *what you are* doesn't. That keeps the freshness of a procedural map without resetting your character.

Are Visitors Only Mystical and Eerie?

No, and I think the game is better if they aren't. All eerie would get monotonous and lose the cozy side. I'd mix:

- **The eerie and mystical:** ghost ships, drowned echoes, deep-sea things that surface when you aim the lamp.
- **Human or human-ish:** a lost sailor who somehow survived on a raft and is stubborn about not being rescued, a traveling merchant whose boat floats strangely over the exposed seabed, a mapmaker who wants your tide journal.
- **Animal and odd:** a heron that steals shiny salvage, a hermit crab the size of a wheelbarrow who collects shells and trades for them.
- **Warm and funny:** a gruff harbor inspector who still insists on filing paperwork for a harbor that no longer exists.

The contrast makes the eerie ones hit harder. When a gentle, funny character shares the same world as something vast and silent, the tone gets depth instead of just atmosphere.

Want me to sketch the first few visitors, or map out the tower's upgrade tree?

can the player talk with the animals

Yes, but I'd make it something the player earns instead of giving them a chat window with every animal from the start.

Three Ways to Do It

1. Full dialogue. Animals just speak. It's simple and warm, but it flattens the mystery and makes the world feel like a fairy tale. The heron stealing your salvage is funnier if it never says a word.

2. No speech, only behavior. You read animals through gestures, trades, and habits. It's elegant and eerie, but it limits how much personality and story they can carry.

3. Earned understanding (my pick). You start by only reading behavior, and over time you learn to actually communicate. It gives you the best of both and adds a progression track that isn't combat or crafting.

How Earned Understanding Could Work

- **The lamp as a translator.** Keepers have always spoken with the sea's creatures through light. Early on, a creature responds to your beam with simple patterns, like a blink for yes or a sweep for come closer. As you restore better lenses and learn more, the signals become richer.
- **Different animals, different languages.** The hermit crab might trade in shells and tapping rhythms. The heron might only ever "talk" through what it steals and what it returns. The deep things might communicate in colors, tides, or dreams. Each species is its own small puzzle, not a universal translator.
- **Understanding is a collectible.** Your tide journal gains a bestiary of phrases and signals you've decoded. Fully learning a creature's language unlocks its story, better trades, and sometimes a clue about the sea.
- **Some stay opaque on purpose.** A few of the vastest creatures never become fully understandable. You get impressions instead of words, which keeps a little awe in the world.

Why It Fits the Game

- It supports the cozy side, since befriending a crab is charming.
- It supports the eerie side, since some conversations are unsettling or incomplete.
- It gives players a reason to revisit creatures, which pairs well with recurring visitors.
- It ties into the lore: if keepers were made to speak with the sea, your growing fluency is part of discovering what you are.

You could also let different animals have different attitudes toward keepers. Some remember the previous one fondly, others hold a grudge, and that's another thread for the mystery.

Want me to sketch how the hermit crab's language would work as a full example, from first meeting to fluent

trade?

what art style you suggest the game will be?

My Pick: Painterly 2.5D with Hand-Drawn Textures

Think soft, watercolor-and-gouache environments with simple, readable character shapes, lit dramatically. Not pixel art, and not realistic 3D.

Why It Fits

The sea is the star, and it needs to feel alive. A painterly style handles water, mud, fog, and wet light beautifully. Glistening seabed, reflective tidal pools, and a horizon that blurs into mist all work better as brushwork than as sharp polygons.

It holds the cozy and the eerie together. A warm lamp glowing in a cold blue-grey dusk is the game's central image, and painterly rendering makes that contrast gorgeous. Pixel art can do cozy well but tends to flatten the vastness. Realism can do eerie but loses the warmth.

It's achievable for a small team. Hand-painted textures on simple low-poly shapes, with a 2.5D camera, give a rich look without the cost of high-fidelity 3D assets. Wrecks, debris, and creatures can be stylized instead of anatomically detailed, which also suits a world of mystical, ambiguous things.

Key Visual Choices

- **A restrained palette that shifts with the tide.** Low tide is muted silvers, greens, and rust. High tide is deep teal and midnight blue. The lamp is always the one warm gold-orange thing, so your eye returns home.
- **Scale through silhouette.** Tiny keeper, huge wrecks, vast creatures. Make the player feel small by keeping the character simple and the world enormous, with lots of negative space and fog.
- **Hand-drawn UI.** The tide journal, watch, and maps should look like real paper, ink, and brass, with smudges and handwriting. The interface itself becomes part of the world.
- **Light as a gameplay language.** Since the lamp communicates with creatures, color and glow should be bold and readable. Everything else stays soft so the light stands out.

Other Directions I Considered

- **Low-poly stylized 3D** (like *Dredge*): moody and efficient, but a bit colder and less tactile than I'd want.
- **Pixel art with strong lighting** (like *Sea of Stars*): charming and cheap to produce, but it makes the endless, open seabed harder to convey.
- **Ink-and-paper illustrated look** (like *Gris* or *Hollow Knight* crossed with storybook art): very beautiful and closest in spirit, but harder to animate at scale in a 2.5D world.

If I had to describe the target feeling in one line: **a wet, windswept storybook, lit by one warm lamp.**

Want me to describe a few key scenes visually, like the opening wake-up or the first low tide, so you can picture it?

what game fits your idea for the art style better , inside or octopath traveler?, and every time the seabed is available will the player have different direction to choose from or it's one available direction that changes every time?

Inside vs. Octopath Traveler

Neither is a perfect match, but Inside is closer in spirit, and Octopath is closer in technique.

Inside gets the mood right: muted palette, a small figure in a vast world, fog and silhouette doing the heavy lifting, and one or two accent colors that guide your eye. The restraint is exactly what *Tidewright* needs. But it's a linear, dark, almost monochrome side-scroller, so it lacks the warmth and the open, wandering feel.

Octopath Traveler gets the technique right: the “HD-2D” approach of detailed sprites in a 3D world with depth-of-field blur, dramatic lighting, and atmospheric effects. That blur and glow would make a lamp-lit seabed gorgeous. But its tone is bright, fantasy-adventure, and its pixel look is a different thing from the painterly brushwork I described.

My blend: Take Inside’s color discipline and sense of scale, then add Octopath’s layered depth and soft focus, but with painted textures instead of pixel sprites. If you want a real-world reference that’s closer than either, *Gris* and *Sable* come nearest to the painterly warmth, and *Journey* for the feeling of crossing a huge empty landscape.

If your team is small and wants a proven pipeline, the Octopath-style approach is the more practical one. If you care most about mood, aim for Inside.

Choosing Where to Go on the Seabed

I’d go with **many directions each time, but a limited number of them reachable on any given tide.** One fixed path would make it a corridor, and total freedom would make the time limit meaningless.

How it works:

- **The seabed is a fixed world with a changing state.** The geography (the trenches, the great ridge, the drowned town district) stays recognizable, so you build real knowledge of it. What changes each tide is what’s exposed, what’s drifted, and what’s buried.
- **Tide height decides reach.** A normal low tide opens the nearby flats and two or three routes. A deeper low tide opens farther regions. A rare lowest tide opens the places you can’t otherwise reach. So the range grows and shrinks with the cycle, instead of the layout being random.
- **Each tide offers a handful of real choices.** Typically three to five viable destinations, each with a tradeoff: close and safe with common salvage, far and risky with rare finds, or a place that’s only open for a short window. Your cart and gear determine which are realistic.
- **Hints help you choose.** Your tide journal, a barometer reading, or a heron seen circling over a certain spot give you reasons to pick one destination over another. That makes planning a skill instead of a coin flip.

Why not one changing path? It removes the feeling of exploration and turns the game into “follow the arrow.” Choice is what makes the journal, the instruments, and the cart upgrades matter.

Why not total freedom? If everything is always open, there’s no pressure and no strategy. The tide’s limits are what give each decision weight.

One extra idea: a few **landmarks that never move**, like a giant ribcage or a toppled lighthouse, so you can always orient yourself. A shifting world works best when it has a few fixed points to navigate by.

Want me to sketch a sample seabed map with the regions and what each tide level unlocks?

the player can create the map and update it in the journal after every exploration?

Yes, and I’d make it one of the game’s signature features. Mapping by hand fits the world: a keeper’s journal, a shifting seabed, and a player who builds real knowledge instead of following a marker.

How Mapping Could Work

The player draws, the game helps. After each expedition, you sit at your desk and fill in the journal map. The game doesn’t auto-reveal everything you walked past. Instead, you place what you remember: landmarks, wrecks, soft ground, safe routes. This could be semi-automatic (the game records your path as a rough ink trail and you annotate it) or fully manual with stamps and a pen tool. I’d lean toward the semi-automatic version, so it feels crafted without becoming a chore.

Layers of information. Your map isn’t one picture, it’s a stack:

- **Fixed layer:** permanent landmarks and geography, which stay valid forever.
- **Tide layer:** where things were on a specific tide, dated and labeled. Wrecks drift, so old notes are marked as possibly outdated.
- **Notes layer:** your own scribbles, like “heron circles here,” “sinks at spring tide,” “don’t bring cart.”

Memory fades. Old entries get slightly smudged or faded, so a map from ten tides ago visibly reads as less trustworthy. That makes updating the journal useful rather than decorative, and it reinforces that the sea is changing.

Why It Works

- **It rewards attention.** Players who observe carefully get better maps and make better decisions.
- **It makes the world feel personal.** Everyone’s journal ends up different, with their own handwriting, shortcuts, and mistakes.
- **It gives the high-tide hours meaning.** Mapping, planning, and annotating is exactly the quiet tower activity we wanted for the waiting period.
- **It pairs with upgrades.** A better sextant improves position accuracy, a better pen lets you add more detail, and a compass or tide gauge adds new map layers.

Things to Watch Out For

- **Don’t make it tedious.** If mapping takes longer than exploring, players will resent it. Automate the boring parts and let players focus on the interesting annotations.
- **Offer an assist option.** Some players want a fully manual map; others want the game to handle it. A toggle keeps it accessible.
- **Let mistakes be forgivable.** A wrongly placed mark should cost you a little time, not wreck your run.

A nice touch: other characters could react to your map. The mapmaker visitor might trade for a good chart, or correct your mistakes with a gentle, passive-aggressive note.

Want me to sketch what a journal page would look like after a few expeditions, or move on to designing the visitors?

about the seabed area, it will be a consistent map but the road available will change every tide? and will better tools gives you a way to open a specific paths?

Yes to both. That’s the structure I’d go with: **a fixed world, with a changing set of open routes, and tools that permanently widen what you can attempt.**

Fixed Map, Changing Routes

The geography never changes. The ridge, the trenches, the drowned town district, and the ribcage are always where you left them, so your knowledge of the world is real and accumulates. What changes each tide is **which routes through that geography are passable**:

- **Water pools and channels.** Some low areas stay flooded on a given tide, cutting off a route that was open last time. A different tide drains them and floods another.
- **Silt and mud.** Wrecks drift and silt shifts, so a firm path may become a sinking bog, and a buried passage may be uncovered.
- **Debris blockages.** A fallen mast or a wall of tangled nets might block a corridor one tide and be gone the next.
- **Tide height.** A deeper low tide opens whole regions that a shallow one doesn’t.

Think of it like a city where the streets are fixed but the roadworks, floods, and closures change daily. You always know the city, but you have to figure out how to get where you want to go today.

How Tools Open Paths

This is where permanent progression pays off. Tools do two different things, and I'd keep both:

1. Tools that unlock specific routes (access). These turn "impassable" into "possible":

- **Mudshoes or a sled** let you cross soft silt that would otherwise trap you.
- **A grappling hook or longer hook** lets you pull down debris blockages or climb onto wreck decks.
- **A hand pump or siphon** drains a small flooded pool blocking a path.
- **A pickaxe or crowbar** breaks through a collapsed wall or a rusted gate.
- **Diving gear** lets you cross deeper pools and eventually work below the waterline.

2. Tools that improve your options (efficiency). These don't open new places, they make existing ones cheaper:

- **A bigger cart** carries more, so far trips become worthwhile.
- **Better lanterns** let you explore dark interiors and read the terrain from farther away.
- **A better tide table** tells you in advance which routes will likely be open, so you can plan.

The Balance

I'd make sure that **no single tool makes the map trivial.** If one upgrade opens everything, the shifting routes stop mattering. Instead:

- Each tool opens *some* paths but not all, so you always have to choose which gear to bring.
- Some routes need a **combination** of tools, such as a cart plus mudshoes plus a hook, which rewards planning.
- Your carrying capacity is limited, so bringing the pump means leaving something else behind.

That last point keeps tool choice meaningful without bringing back temporary buffs. The tools are permanent, but each expedition you decide **which ones to load on the cart**.

A Nice Result

A route you couldn't take early in the game becomes a milestone later. You'll remember the passage you kept seeing, blocked by a collapsed gate, and the day you finally brought the crowbar. Your journal will have a note from twenty tides earlier: *"Gate in the north ridge. Need something strong."*

Want me to sketch a sample region with its routes and what tools each one needs?

in the time the player in the lighthouse, i get it that there is stuff to do and visits, but both of them are short compare to the rest of the time when we use real time

Designing how real-time tide cycles fill game activity time.

You've found the biggest design tension in the idea. If the tide follows a real 24-hour clock, the tower has hours of high water to fill, and a few chores and a visitor won't do it. Nobody sits in a lighthouse for ten real hours.

Reframe: It's an Appointment Game

Games on a real clock, like *Animal Crossing*, aren't played continuously. Players check in a few times a day, do a handful of things, and leave. So the high tide shouldn't be designed as a stretch you sit through. It should be the time you're *away*, with the tower doing things while you are. That changes what the lighthouse needs.

Fixes I'd Combine

1. Spread the tower's events across the high tide. Instead of one burst of activity, visitors arrive at different hours: dusk, midnight, pre-dawn. Each check-in has something new, which gives people a reason to come back several times per cycle.

2. Make restoration run on real-time timers. Drying a waterlogged logbook, curing a repaired hull plank, or letting a lens cool and set takes hours, not minutes. You start the work, leave, and come back to the result. This is the same loop as planting crops in farming games.

3. Give the player a legitimate way to skip. The brass tide-clock from earlier fits here. Going to bed advances time to the next low tide, with a small cost like a shorter expedition, so skipping is a choice with weight, not a cheat.

4. Don't make high tide dead time for exploration. Later in the game, a rowboat or diving gear opens high-tide content: visiting the rocky islands, fishing the deep channels, or diving the drowned town. High tide becomes a different mode of play instead of a pause.

5. Add depth to the tower itself. Long-form activities like decoding a letter across several sessions, building out rooms, or studying the bestiary give players something substantial to do if they *want* to stay, without forcing them to.

The Bigger Question: Shorten the Cycle?

A 24-hour cycle is a lovely idea, but it may be the wrong number. A cycle of around **4 to 6 real hours**, with roughly an hour or two of low tide, would fit how people actually play: one expedition per session, and a natural rhythm across a day. Players who want a slower rhythm could pick a "long tide" mode.

My recommendation is a shorter default cycle, the timers and skip option from points 2 and 3, and high-tide exploration unlocked by mid-game. Together they make the waiting feel like part of the game instead of a gap in it.

Do you want the tide to feel like a real-life clock you live alongside, or would you be happy with a faster, more game-like rhythm? That choice decides how much of the rest I'd build around it.

maybe doing the same time system as stardew valley but longer than a day of stardew valley, maybe the player enjoys the game and wants to continue to play and not wait real time

That's a better fit than anything I proposed. A Stardew-style in-game clock removes the waiting problem entirely, and it settles the time-travel question too, since there's no real-time clock to cheat. The tide becomes a system the player lives inside instead of a schedule they have to wait out.

How I'd Build It

The game clock runs while you play. One in-game tide cycle takes a fixed amount of real play time, and the clock pauses in menus and dialogue, as in Stardew. Players can play for as long as they want and never hit a wall.

Tide cycle length. A Stardew day is about 13 real minutes. For *Tidewright* I'd aim for a full cycle of roughly **25 to 35 real minutes**, split like this:

- **Low tide (about 12 to 18 minutes):** the expedition. It's long enough to reach somewhere meaningful and haul something back, short enough that every turn-back decision still feels tense.
- **High tide (about 10 to 15 minutes):** the tower. Restoration, visitors, mapping, and crafting fit comfortably in this window, and it no longer feels thin, because you aren't waiting through hours of it.

That also fixes the earlier problem. Tower activities that felt too short against a 10-hour window feel right against a 12-minute one.

What Changes Because of This

- **Restoration and crafting use game time, not real time.** Drying a logbook takes “two tides,” not eight real hours. You start it, go on your expedition, and it’s ready when you return. That keeps the farming-game satisfaction of planting and harvesting without any real-world waiting.
- **Visitors arrive on in-game schedules.** A ghost ship docks at midnight on the third tide, and the heron shows up at dusk. You can plan around them and learn their rhythms.
- **The lowest tide becomes a calendar event.** Instead of a rare real-world weekly event, it’s an in-game cycle, like a Stardew festival: “the great low tide arrives in six tides.” Players prepare for it.
- **Time-skipping is gone as a problem.** You can add a bed or a tide-clock to fast-forward the quiet high-tide hours if someone wants to, with no cheating concern.
- **Long-term structure.** You can add larger cycles on top: a spring-tide week, seasons, storm periods. A “year” gives the world a shape and a long-term arc.

Pressure Without Frustration

Since you don’t want players feeling punished, I’d borrow Stardew’s gentler rules:

- **If the tide catches you, you aren’t lost.** You get swept back to the tower, losing part of your haul or some time, but not your progress. The risk is real, the penalty is mild.
- **A clear tide indicator.** The wrist watch from earlier shows the water’s return as a creeping line, so you always know how much time is left.
- **Upgrades extend your window.** Better boots, carts, and instruments let you do more in each low tide, which gives progression a feeling of power.

One Decision for You

The main thing to settle is whether the **tide cycle is the “day”**, so each cycle is a complete unit like a Stardew day, or whether you’d also keep a day and night cycle inside it. I’d go with the tide as the day: one clock, one rhythm, and it keeps the game’s identity tied to the sea. Night could be part of high tide, which fits the lamp-aiming and eerie visitors we already planned.

Want me to lay out what a single full tide cycle might look like minute by minute, from waking up to the next low tide?

the tide in real life connected to moon right?

Yes. The moon’s gravity pulls on the oceans, creating a bulge of water on the side of Earth facing the moon. A second bulge forms on the opposite side (because Earth itself is pulled toward the moon more than the far water is, and because of the rotating system’s inertia). As Earth rotates, a given coastline passes through these bulges, which is why most places get two high tides and two low tides roughly every 24 hours and 50 minutes. That extra 50 minutes is because the moon moves along its orbit while Earth spins, so each day it takes a bit longer to catch up to the same moon position.

The sun matters too, just less. Its pull is about half as strong as the moon’s effect on tides.

- **Spring tides** happen at new moon and full moon, when the sun, Earth, and moon line up. Their pulls combine, giving the highest highs and lowest lows.
- **Neap tides** happen at the quarter moons, when the sun and moon pull at right angles. The pulls partly cancel, so the tidal range is smallest.

That’s a gift for *Tidewright*, because it hands you a ready-made structure for the rare events we’ve been discussing:

- **The great low tide** could be a spring tide at a particular moon phase, the one that opens the farthest regions of the seabed.
- **Neap tides** would be the shallow, restrictive cycles where only nearby routes are open, good for restoration and tower work.
- **A lunar calendar** gives the world a natural rhythm of roughly 29.5 days, with the moon visible in the sky from the lamp room. Players learn to read it, and your tide table and sextant become instruments for predicting what's coming.
- **A strange moon** could even be part of the mystery. If the sea stopped behaving like water, maybe the moon is no longer behaving like a moon, or the keepers' lamp is somehow tied to it.

It also makes your tide journal richer: players could track the moon phase alongside the water level and notice the pattern themselves, which is the kind of discovery that feels earned rather than explained.

Want me to work the lunar cycle into the in-game calendar, say how many tides make up a lunar month and what each phase does to the seabed?

so we need nee the player to keep track of days of the month and season to learn the patterns

Yes, learning the patterns requires the player to know where they are in the cycle. But I'd make the game do the bookkeeping and leave the interpretation to the player.

What the Player Tracks

Since the tide is the "day," the calendar is counted in tides:

- **Tide count:** each cycle is one day. The journal's cover page shows the current tide number.
- **Lunar month:** about 29 or 30 tides, so one full moon cycle. You could shorten it to around 14 to 16 tides if a full month feels too long for a game, as Stardew does with its 28-day seasons.
- **Seasons:** a few lunar months each, changing the weather, the wildlife, and which wrecks and visitors appear.

Make It Diegetic, Not a Menu

Players shouldn't need a spreadsheet. The game gives them ways to see the cycle in the world:

- **The moon in the lamp room window.** Its phase is always visible, so a glance tells you whether a spring tide is coming. Experienced players read it like a farmer reads the sky.
- **A tide-table page that fills in automatically.** Each tide, the journal logs the date, moon phase, water height, and weather, so the raw data is always there.
- **A calendar on the wall.** Visitors, festivals like the great low tide, and your own reminders get marked on it, like Stardew's bulletin board.
- **Seasonal cues.** Light, bird migrations, and the color of the water signal the season even if you aren't looking at a calendar.

Where the Discovery Lives

What the game logs is *what happened*. What it doesn't do is *tell you the rule*. The player notices that the farthest region opens only around the full moon, or that a certain visitor appears after storms, and writes it in their notes layer: "Full moon: ridge drains. Check northern route." That's the satisfying part, and it's why the journal matters.

You can scale how much help the player gets:

- **Early game:** the journal shows only date and moon phase.
- **With better instruments:** a tide table that predicts a few tides ahead, or a barometer that hints at storms.
- **Optional assist mode:** a toggle that highlights confirmed patterns for players who don't want to deduce them.

One Thing to Avoid

Don't let the calendar become homework. If players feel they must memorize dates to avoid missing things, it turns cozy into stressful. That's why the earlier rule matters: **nothing essential is locked to a single date.** Rare events repeat each lunar month or each year, so a missed spring tide just means you prepare better for the next one.

Want me to lay out a sample lunar month, showing what each phase does to the seabed and which tide events fall on which days?

from all the plan for the game until i think the player won't face enemies that he has to kill right? if no enemies so no use for hunger system it will add pressure . will there be an end to the game? when the player discover the secret of the sea will he has the choice to continue like in stradew valley that there is a kind of a goal until the third year? or will the player choose to end and stop being a keeper?

No Enemies, No Hunger

You're right on both. The game's pressure already comes from the tide: the clock, the rising water, the limited cart space, and the choice of where to go. That's a cleaner source of tension than a monster to fight, and it keeps the tone observational and cozy-eerie.

A hunger system would work against that for a few reasons:

- **It's a second clock on top of the tide clock.** Two timers competing for attention muddies the one pressure that matters.
- **It punishes the wrong thing.** You'd be managing meals instead of reading the sea, and it pushes players toward a chore loop.
- **It only makes sense with a threat.** Survival games use hunger to make combat and exploration costly. Without enemies, it's just a tax.

If you want a little life-sustaining texture, make it **comfort instead of need**. A hot meal at the stove could give a small, permanent-feeling benefit like a better night's rest, or unlock a visitor's story, but skipping it never hurts you. Cooking becomes a pleasant ritual, not a requirement.

The danger in the world is **environmental**: sinking silt, a fast-returning tide, a collapsing wreck, a creature that's startled by the wrong light. These cost you time or part of your haul, never your life, which fits the gentle penalty we already decided on.

An Ending, and a Choice

Yes, I'd give the game a real ending. A mystery needs a payoff, and an ending is what makes the story mean something. But I'd copy the Stardew idea you mentioned: **the ending is a milestone, not a wall.**

The structure:

1. **A main goal with a clear arc.** Over the first couple of in-game years, the player works toward uncovering the sea's secret and stopping or reversing the rising tide. Like the Community Center, it's the spine of the game, and it gives purpose to salvage, mapping, and upgrades.
2. **A climactic revelation.** The final low tide, probably an extraordinary one, where you reach the deepest point on the seabed and learn what the keepers are and why the sea changed.
3. **A real choice.** This is where your idea fits best.

The Choice at the End

Instead of one outcome, the player decides what the keeper becomes:

- **Stay as the keeper.** You accept the role, the sea settles into a stable rhythm, and the game continues in a calmer post-game. The tide no longer threatens the tower, so exploring turns into pure curiosity and collecting.
- **Release the sea.** You free it from the keeper's lamp, and the tide changes for good. The world shifts into something new, with a different seabed and different visitors, which can be an epilogue or a second mode.
- **Hand it on.** You find or train a successor, close your logbook, and walk away from the tower. It's an ending, but a warm one, with a final montage of the people and creatures you helped.

Each could carry a different emotional note: duty, freedom, or legacy. They also give the mystery's answer real weight, because the player's choice answers "what does a keeper owe the sea?"

Keeping the Game Going

For players who want to continue, the post-game can include:

- **Fully open exploration,** since the rising-tide pressure is gone.
- **Completionist goals:** finish the bestiary, fully decode every creature's language, map every region, restore every wreck.
- **New visitors and slow stories** that only appear after the secret is revealed.
- **A quiet "keeper's life" mode,** where the tide cycles continue as pure atmosphere.

If the player chooses to leave, the game should honor that as a complete ending instead of treating it as quitting. You could still let them reload before the final choice, so nobody feels locked out of the other endings.

Want me to sketch the final low tide, what the player does and sees, or work out how the three endings differ?

release the sea and enter a different mode like game plus options in games? with changed difficulty? or a whole new visitors ?, finding a successor in one of the visitor? will training them also take time?

Release the Sea: A New Mode, Not a Harder One

I'd treat it as a **transformed world instead of a New Game+ with a difficulty slider**. Classic New Game+ (replay with your gear, tougher enemies) fits games built on combat. Here there are no enemies, and the tide pressure is the heart of the game, so "harder" would just mean a shorter low tide, which feels like a punishment instead of a new experience.

What I'd do instead is let the ending change the *rules of the world*:

- **The tide becomes natural.** It's no longer a keeper's burden, it's a real tide following the moon. The rising-water threat is gone, but the cycle is truer to what we discussed: spring tides, neap tides, and seasons, all driven by the lunar calendar.
- **The seabed is rearranged.** The geography you mastered is still there, but the sea has changed it. Old wrecks are gone, new regions are exposed, and your journal's old maps are now historical documents, partly wrong. That brings back the joy of exploring without any artificial difficulty.
- **A whole new cast of visitors.** The eerie creatures bound to the old sea leave or change, and new arrivals come with the freed tide: travelers, fishers, a settlement slowly forming on the shore. The world shifts from a haunted sea to a living one.
- **Your gear carries over.** The cart, boots, and instruments are yours, but with new uses. You could even rework them for the new world, which gives your old progression a second life.

If you want an optional challenge layer, make it **self-chosen goals** instead of a difficulty setting: chart the

entire new seabed, find every wreck, and so on.

Finding a Successor

Yes, and I like that it comes from the visitors. By the late game, players will have long relationships with certain characters, so the choice carries real emotional weight.

Who qualifies? A few visitors could be candidates, each with a different personality and reason for wanting the lamp:

- A **stubborn sailor** who never wanted rescue and finally finds somewhere to stay.
- The **mapmaker** who has always wanted your journal and the knowledge in it.
- A **young drifter** who keeps turning up at the tower, curious and slightly lost.
- Possibly a **creature**, if the player has learned its language, which would be the most surprising and moving option.

Who they are depends on what you've done. Candidates only appear if you've completed their questlines, so the successor is the result of earlier relationships, not a menu choice at the end.

Does Training Take Time?

I'd say yes, but make it **part of the game's final stretch** instead of a separate grind, and keep it scaled to the tide clock:

- **A handful of tides, not a long chore.** Training could take around five to ten tide cycles, enough to feel like a handover without dragging.
- **Each tide teaches one thing.** Lamp, tide table, journal, safe routes. You pass on what you've learned, and the successor's progress reflects how well you taught it.
- **The player does it alongside normal play.** The successor tags along on low-tide expeditions, helps in the tower at high tide, and makes small mistakes that the player gently corrects.
- **The player's own knowledge matters.** What the successor learns is based on what you've actually discovered, so a thorough journal gives a stronger handover. Your notes become a literal inheritance.
- **A final test.** Near the end, the successor takes one tide alone while you wait in the tower, watching the lamp. It's tense in a quiet way, and then they come back safely. Only then do you leave.

If it fits the tone, there's a nice touch here: the previous keeper's unfinished note from the opening could finally be completed, in your handwriting, and left for your successor to find.

Want me to compare the three endings side by side, or draft the successor's first-tide-alone scene?

how about not new cast of visitors but seeing the visitors settle in areas? you can still learn more about them and help their requests. and what triggers the player character to seek a successor?

Visitors Who Settle

That's better than my idea, and I'd drop the new cast. A fresh set of characters would make the player's earlier relationships feel like they were only a prelude. If the visitors you've helped now put down roots, the post-game becomes the payoff for those relationships.

How it could work:

- **The seabed becomes a place to live.** With the tide no longer threatening anyone, visitors choose spots that fit them. The hermit crab claims a shell-strewn flat, the harbor inspector sets up a tiny office beside a drowned quay, the stubborn sailor builds a hut on a ridge. You can see the world fill up with lived-in places, and your old map gets new annotations.
- **Their homes reflect your history together.** Where they settle depends on what you did for them. The mapmaker builds near the route you charted most carefully, and the sailor settles by the wreck whose compass you returned.
- **They stop being visitors and become neighbors.** Instead of arriving on tide schedules, they have routines. You stop by, and they're at their post, at the market, or out on their own errands.
- **Their requests change in kind.** Before, requests were about recovering lost things. Now they're about building a life: finding materials for a roof, a lamp for the settlement, a recipe someone half-remembers. Your salvage and crafting still matter, with a warmer purpose.
- **There's still more to learn.** Settled characters can have stories they never told while the sea was threatening everything. Fully fluent animals might share things that only come out when they feel safe, which gives the language-learning track a post-game reward.

The eerie ones: I'd let some stay strange. A ghost ship that never settles, or a vast creature that remains offshore, keep a trace of the mystery in a gentler world. Not everything has to become a neighbor.

You could even have a **gathering place**, like a small village hub growing around the lighthouse, so the old tower becomes the center of a community instead of an isolated outpost.

What Makes the Keeper Seek a Successor

I'd avoid a single "now find a successor" prompt. It works better if the reason grows out of the story, and if it's the **player's own reflection**, not a system demand. A few triggers, which you could combine:

- **The keeper's age and cost.** Early on, logbooks show your handwriting across years. As the mystery unfolds, you realize the lamp has been keeping you here, and that each keeper gave up something. The player notices their own journal entries getting shakier, or their tower routine becoming harder, which signals that this can't go on forever.
- **The previous keeper's unfinished note.** The note from the opening could be the seed. Finishing it requires understanding what it was trying to say, and the answer is that the keeper must leave the lamp to someone, or the sea will take it back. The ending of the mystery tells you what needs to happen.
- **The sea's own signal.** The lamp starts answering differently, or the tide begins to ask a question the player can't answer alone. It doesn't command you, it gives you a nudge: *the lamp needs someone who wants to be here.*
- **A visitor's request.** Someone close to you asks the question directly: "Who's going to keep this after you?" It's gentler and more personal than a system message, and it fits the cozy tone.
- **The player simply wants to go.** After finishing the mystery, you might feel the pull to see what's beyond the sea you've been tied to. A map page appears with places beyond the seabed, and a note in your own handwriting: *I'd like to see them.*

I'd lean on the last two together. The visitor's question plants the idea, and the player's own longing finishes it, so leaving feels like a choice, not an obligation.

It also solves a design problem. If the player has an ending path that depends on their own readiness, the game doesn't need to force it. The successor option appears once the mystery is solved and a candidate has completed their arc, and the player can choose to act on it whenever they're ready.

Want me to work out how the three endings fit together now that visitors settle in the world, or write the scene where a visitor asks who will keep the lamp?

the choice is when the visitor asks who's going to keep this after you?

That's a strong choice, because it makes the question personal. The game never says "you must pick a

successor.” Someone you’ve come to trust asks, and the player has to answer.

Make the Question Land

Who asks matters. It shouldn’t be a random visitor. The question carries weight when it comes from someone whose arc you’ve finished, because they’ve seen what the lamp costs and they care about you. It could also come from different characters depending on who you’re closest to, so each playthrough has its own version of the moment.

When it appears. After the sea’s secret is revealed, and only once at least one candidate has completed their arc. Before that, the question would have no answer. I’d have it come up in a quiet moment, not a cutscene: at the stove during high tide, or on the stairs, or at the end of a long day of repairs. The quieter the scene, the harder it hits.

It doesn’t have to be answered right away. The player can reply “I don’t know yet,” and the question stays in the world. The visitor doesn’t ask again, but the journal gets a new page headed *Who keeps the lamp?*, and the choice remains open until the player acts on it.

How the Player Answers

Give the reply a few honest options instead of a yes/no:

- **Name someone.** Choose a candidate, and the training period begins.
- **“I don’t know yet.”** The question is kept, and nothing is lost. The game continues as the stay or release path.
- **“Nobody.”** Valid and meaningful. It points toward the stay ending, or toward releasing the sea so no keeper is needed.
- **“Maybe you.”** If the asker is a candidate themselves, the question can flip. This is a lovely twist, because they may have been asking for themselves, or fearing the answer.

That last one is worth keeping. Sometimes a person asks “who will keep this?” because they want to be the one.

Why This Fits the Three Endings

The same question can open all three paths, which ties the endings together:

- **Hand it on:** the player names a successor and begins training.
- **Stay:** the player answers “nobody,” or keeps deferring, and chooses to remain.
- **Release the sea:** the player answers that the lamp shouldn’t need a keeper at all, and the question becomes the reason to free the sea.

So the visitor’s line isn’t just a trigger for one ending. It’s the moment the game asks what the player wants the keeper’s role to be, and every ending is a different answer.

A Possible Echo

Because the opening note was unfinished mid-sentence, you could have the question echo it. The previous keeper’s note might end on a similar thought, and the player realizes someone once asked *them* the same thing. Finishing the note after you’ve answered gives the story a quiet circle.

Want me to write that scene, the visitor asking the question and the player’s possible replies, so you can see how the tone would feel?

i like it, it gives the player meaning outside the game, should he finish this "chapter" - game and move on or stay in that world

That’s the layer that could make the game stick with people. The keeper’s question, “stay, hand it on, or let it go?”, is also the question a player faces about the game itself. Anyone who has put 100 hours into a cozy

game knows the feeling of finishing the story and wondering whether to keep living there or close the book. *Tidewright* can make that feeling part of the story instead of leaving it unspoken.

Treat Both Choices as Complete

The most important rule is that **neither choice is the "wrong" one**:

- **Staying isn't failing to finish.** The post-game is a real place with ongoing stories, not leftover content. Players who stay should feel they chose a life, not skipped an ending.
- **Leaving isn't quitting.** The handover ending should be as rich as the others, with a proper farewell, a last walk through the settled seabed, and a final image that earns the closure.
- **Neither is a punishment or a reward.** No better ending, no hidden "true" path that makes the other feel lesser.

Let the Game Acknowledge the Player's Real Time

Because the game has a calendar, a lunar year, and a long arc, players will have spent real hours in this world. You can let the ending notice that:

- **A closing page in the journal** summarizing the years: tides survived, wrecks restored, creatures understood, friends made. It reads like a keeper's memoir, not a stats screen.
- **A gentle farewell for those who leave.** The settled visitors wave from their homes as you walk away. The lamp is lit behind you.
- **A quiet welcome for those who stay.** The world goes on without needing you to prove anything, and visitors say so: *"You don't have to do anything today."*

That last line matters. Many cozy games leave players feeling obligated to keep optimizing. This one can explicitly give them permission to simply be there.

A Few Practical Touches

- **Save after the ending.** Let players keep a post-ending save in the world they chose, and let them go back before the choice to see another path. Nobody should feel locked in or locked out.
- **Make the epilogue shaped by what they did.** If they trained a successor, the successor appears later in your journal, writing their own entries. If they stayed, the neighbors age slowly around them. If they released the sea, the new tide returns on its natural rhythm and the old maps become keepsakes.
- **Don't over-explain the theme.** The best version never says "this is about letting go of games." It just gives the player a real choice and trusts them to feel the parallel.

The game ends up being about how to leave a place well, or how to stay in one without needing it to be a job, which is a rare and quietly moving thing for a game to be about.

Do you want to step back and pull everything together into a one-page overview of the game (premise, core loop, progression, endings), or keep going into a specific piece like the first few visitors?

what's the game perspective , isometric like tunic or side scroller like hollow knight?

Choosing a visual perspective to recommend for the game.

My Pick: Angled Top-Down (Isometric-Style)

For *Tidewright* I'd go with the *Tunic* direction, a fixed three-quarter camera looking down at the world, not a side-scroller. It's a better fit for what this game does.

Why Not a Side-Scroller

Hollow Knight works because its world is a network of corridors, and movement is about platforming and combat. This game's core is different:

- **The seabed is a wide, open space.** You choose between routes across flats, ridges, and channels. A side view turns that into a left-or-right line, and the “where do I go today?” decision, which we’ve built a lot around, mostly disappears.
- **The cart needs room.** Hauling a cart across soft silt and around debris is a top-down problem. In a side view it becomes awkward physics.
- **Mapping works naturally from above.** Your journal map is a top-down drawing. If the game is also shown from above, what you see and what you draw match, so learning the map feels direct.
- **Scale is easier to show.** A tiny keeper crossing a huge exposed seabed reads best from a raised angle, where you can see far and feel how empty it is.
- **There’s no combat to justify a side view.** Side-scrollers shine when moving and fighting are the same thing. Here you’re observing, hauling, and planning.

Why the Angled View Fits

- **Depth and fog.** A tilted camera lets mist, distant wrecks, and the returning waterline layer into the background, which is exactly what the painterly look I suggested wants.
- **The rising tide is visible.** From above you can watch the waterline creep across the flats toward you, so the pressure is something you see, not just a UI line on your watch.
- **It supports the Octopath-style depth blur.** Foreground and background softness works beautifully when the camera is angled.
- **Wrecks become explorable spaces.** You can walk around and into a ship, with the hull peeling away as you enter, as *Tunic* and many isometric games do.

The Lighthouse Can Be Different

Here’s a nice option: **use a different view inside the tower.** The lighthouse could be a cutaway cross-section, a side-on view of the tower with each floor visible, like a dollhouse. You see the stove, the workbench, the lamp room stacked above you.

That gives you the best of both:

- **Outside:** open, angled top-down exploration.
- **Inside:** a cozy, readable side view where every room is visible at once, and you can watch your tower grow as you upgrade it.

The shift in perspective also marks the change of mood between expedition and home, which reinforces the tide rhythm.

A Few Cautions

- **Fixed camera, not free-rotating.** It keeps the painterly composition controlled and avoids hiding things behind objects.
- **Make sure the player can read the ground.** Firm sand, soft silt, and pools need to be distinct from above, since that’s how players plan routes.
- **Avoid pure top-down.** A slight tilt keeps characters and wrecks looking like objects with height, not flat shapes.

If you’d like to see it differently, there’s also a **side view for dives** later in the game. When the player gets diving gear, descending into a flooded wreck or trench could shift to a side-on view, which gives the deep a distinct feel from the flats.

Want me to describe how a single low-tide expedition would look on screen from this camera, from leaving the tower to turning back?